Independent At-Home Bitcoin Self-Custody

Plebum Dominium

(PLAY-boom doh-MIN-ee-oom)

Absolute Ownership by the Common People

“Pleb” is an everyday Bitcoiner. “Dominium” is Latin for absolute ownership. This guide is for the Bitcoiner who wants to build a secure, self-custody Bitcoin wallet from the ground up — bypassing the need for a company, an app, or a custodian to manage or store it.

Why this guide: eliminate single points of failure

This guide does that — securely and privately. None of these can take your money:

- One seed that can spend by itself
- An app or an exchange
- One place
- One device, one company
- A photo, a note, or a password manager

The process, start to finish

Seven steps. Each one links to its sheet. Nothing is skipped, nothing is reordered.

1. Two boots

The same computer, used twice. The **first boot** stays on the network and only watches. The **second boot** is Tails — network off, one seed, then a full shutdown.

2. Check the files

Every file comes from **its own site**. Hash and signature are checked — if either fails, the file is **deleted**. Two tools must agree before the work continues.

3. Make the keys

Casino dice make the randomness. Faces **1–4 are kept**, 5 and 6 are rolled again. The computer shuts down between keys. **Two programs must print the same 24 words.**

4. Two of three

The wallet needs **any two of the three keys** to spend. One key alone cannot move the long-term fund.

5. Practice spend

A **small amount** comes in. The first seed signs, the computer shuts down, the second seed signs — then the payment is broadcast. Savings don’t move until this works.

6. Metal + map

The three keys are **stamped into titanium** and kept at three addresses. The wallet map travels with the record of those places — and the map is **not another key**.

7. House rules

The limits of the method. A convenience is **never** allowed to break one of them.

House rules

- **No photos** — no seed, plate, or word-bearing screen on a camera.
- **Networking off before the seed** — a seed never sits on a machine that had the network up.
- **One seed per boot** — load Seed 1, sign, full shutdown, then Seed 2.
- **Hash fails → stop** — do not improvise; redownload from the project's own site.
- **Hardware later** — optional signer, different vendors if more than one.